CITY COLLEGE
OF CAGAYAN DE ORO
EST 2023
AIM HIGHER

CENTER FOR
HUMAN RIGHTS
EDUCATION
CITY COLLEGE
OF CAGAYAN DE ORO

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CITY COLLEGE
OF CAGAYAN DE ORO
AIM HIGHER

CENTER FOR HUMAN RIGHTS EDUCATION (CHRE)

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Chapter 1

FOUNDATIONAL INFORMATION

The office of the Center for Human Rights Education (CHRE) of the City College of Cagayan de Oro City aims at promoting and advancing human rights awareness, understanding, and advocacy among students, faculty, and staff within and outside the academic community. It underscores at developing a culture of tolerance, respect and non-discrimination through facilitating training and capacity-building workshops, for teaching and non-teaching personnel, students and community on human rights education.

RATIONALE AND SIGNIFICANCE OF ESTABLISHING CHRE AT CCCDO

1. **Cultivating Human Rights Champions:** The center can play a pivotal role in nurturing future generations of human rights defenders by providing comprehensive education on human rights principles, international law, and local contexts.
2. **Fostering Research and Knowledge Production:** It can serve as a hub for research and scholarship on human rights issues, contributing to the development of new knowledge and innovative approaches to human rights promotion and protection.
3. **Promoting Human Rights Advocacy:** The center can support students and faculty in engaging in human rights advocacy activities, such as public speaking, community organizing, and legal advocacy.
4. **Strengthening Institutional Commitment to Human Rights:** By establishing a center dedicated to human rights education, institutions of higher education can demonstrate their commitment to upholding human rights principles and values.
5. **Building Partnerships and Collaborations:** The center can facilitate partnerships and collaborations with other organizations and institutions working on human rights issues, both locally and internationally.

In a nutshell the establishment of a center of **Human Rights Education** at the City Colege of Cagaayn de Oro is a significant step towards promoting a culture of respect for human rights and fostering a more just and equitable society.

I.1 VMGO

Vision: A world where human rights are universally respected, protected, and promoted, and where all individuals enjoy their fundamental rights without discrimination.

Mission: To advance human rights education, research, and advocacy in higher education and beyond, fostering a culture of respect for human dignity and equality.

Goals:

Education: To provide comprehensive and accessible human rights education to students, faculty, and staff, equipping them with the knowledge and skills to understand, defend, and promote human rights.

Research: To conduct rigorous research on human rights issues, contributing to the development of new knowledge and innovative approaches to human rights promotion and protection.

Advocate: To support students, faculty, and staff in engaging in human rights advocacy activities, both locally and internationally.

Collaborate: To foster partnerships with other organizations and institutions working on human rights issues, both within and outside the academic community.

Influence Policy: To advocate for policies and practices that promote human rights at all levels, from local to international.

Promote Cultural Understanding: To foster intercultural understanding and respect, recognizing the diversity of human experiences and perspectives.

Empower Communities: To support community-based initiatives that promote human rights and address the needs of marginalized groups.

CHAPTER 2

PROGRAM ACTIVITY MANAGEMENT

1. Education and Training
    - Workshops and Seminars: Organizing workshops and seminars on various human rights topics.
    - Guest Lectures: Inviting human rights experts and activists to speak to students and faculty.
2. Research and Advocacy:
    - Research Projects: Supporting faculty and students in conducting research on human rights issues.
    - Advocacy Campaigns: Organizing advocacy campaigns to promote human rights and address specific issues.
    - Publications: Publishing research papers, reports, and articles on human rights.
3. Community Engagement:
    - Community Partnerships: Building partnerships with local organizations and communities.
    - Human Rights Education for Communities: Providing human rights education to community members.
    - Community-Based Research: Conducting research in partnership with communities.
    - Volunteer Programs: Organizing volunteer programs to support human rights initiatives.
4. International Cooperation:
    - Participate in international networks and collaborations.
    - Organize and attend international conferences on human rights.

Services

- Providing comprehensive education on human rights principles, international law, and local contexts.
- Offering research support, including funding, mentorship, and access to resources.
- Providing advocacy support, including training, networking, and legal assistance.
- Connecting students and faculty with community-based organizations.
- Providing opportunities for networking and professional development.
- Maintaining a resource center with books, articles, and other materials on human rights.



Composition of CHRE

Director: Oversees the overall operations of the CHRE, including program development, fundraising, and strategic planning.

Program Coordinators: Manages specific programs and activities, such as education, research, and advocacy.

Administrative Assistant: Handles administrative tasks, such as scheduling, budgeting, and communications.

Chapter 3
HUMAN RIGHTS EDUCATION LEGAL FOUNDATION

This chapter presents basic knowledge in understanding human rights education. It provides the legal foundations that support human rights education, internationally and nationally. Furthermore, it elaborates the importance and the goals of human rights education. The chapter ends by identifying the need for human rights education in various sectors of society, and situating this need in a larger systems framework.

A. Principles and Legal Foundations of Human Rights Education

What core treatises and declarations support human rights education?

The preamble of the UDHR exhorts individuals and organs of society to "strive by teaching and education to promote respect for these rights and freedoms" (UN, n.d.). This is further underscored in Article 26.2 of the UDHR as it urges that "education shall be directed to the full development of the human personality and to the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms" (OHCHR,

Human rights). Purposely, the International Conference on Human Rights in Tehran held in 1968, Resolution No. XX called upon States "to ensure that all means of education should be employed so that the youth grow up and develop in a spirit of respect for human dignity and for equal rights of all men and all peoples without discrimination" (OHCHR, n.d.).

With these subsequent exhortations on the role that education plays in furthering universal human rights, the UN General Assembly proclaimed the UN Decade for Human Rights Education from 1995 to 2004 "to build and strengthen programmes and capacities for human rights education at the international, regional, national, and local levels." Stemming from this is the proclamation of the World Programme for Human Rights Education beginning in 2005 and is continuously ongoing. In December 2011, the UN General Assembly adopted the United Nations Declaration on Human Rights Education and Training, where Article 1 states: "Everyone has the right to know, seek and receive information about all human rights and fundamental freedoms and should have access to human rights education and training." These core international treaties and declarations include the different elements and provisions on human rights education.

Human Rights Education

What is Human Rights Education?

In the proclamation of the UN Decade for Human Rights Education December 1994, the General Assembly defined human rights education to be more than mere provision of information but rather the development of "a comprehensive lifelong process by which people at all levels in development and in all strata of society learn respect for the dignity of others and the means and methods of ensuring that respect in all societies" (OHCHR, UNDHRE, para. 6).

Human rights embody the hopes of human beings. Human rights education thus serves to empower people by setting standards and producing change toward the attainment of these rights (OMB, n.d.). Human rights education is defined by UN

(n.d.) as the process of empowerment of every individual or community to develop their behavior, attitude, skills, and knowledge to contribute to the building and promotion of a universal culture of human rights. It begins with the individual and branches out to encompass the community at large. According to the Plan of Action for the United Nations Decade for Human Rights Education, 1995-2004 human rights education may take the form of training, dissemination and information efforts (OHCHR, Plan of Action).

As emphasized in the preceding discussion, human rights education takes its authority on human rights principles ensconced in national and international charters and laws. Central to its methods are human rights values that promote the holistic development of people. This should lead people to take action as an individual, and as a member of local and global communities (Bertlesmann Foundation, 2002, as cited in OMB, n.d.).

What is the history of human rights education in the Philippines?

With its institution in 1987, the Commission on Human Rights of the Philippines (CHRP) is mandated by the 1987 Constitution to establish "a continuing program of research, education, and information to enhance respect for the primacy of human rights" and to recommend to the legislative body "effective measures to mote human rights" (Ofreneo, 2007). Given its constitutional mandate and its vision a Philippine society that deeply values the dignity of every person and fully respects aman rights," human rights education is an indispensable arm of CHR in ensuring the ong-term prevention of human rights abuses. Moreover, it is a crucial investment in making a culture of human rights a reality in our society.

The First Commission adopted the Human Rights Education and Training Program (HRETP) from its Short-Term Human Rights Education Program Plan in 1988 with a redefinition of its program's target audiences. From a focus on potential violators of human rights, this was expanded to two major categories alluding to the

potential violators and the potential victims (Ofreneo, 2007). In response to the UN Decade of Human Rights Education, the CHRP drew out decade-long sectoral human rights education plans at the regional and national levels resulting in the Philippine Human Rights Education Plan for 1998-2007. Its general objective was "an organized, functional, effective and relevant Human Rights Education Program in formal, non-formal, and community-based sectors has been established" (Ofreneo, 2007).

The extent of implementation of the Decade Plan allowed for the institutionalization of human rights education in the Philippine educational system, in the pillars of justice (police/law enforcers, military/security forces), in the civil service and barangays, in the private sector, and among vulnerable groups (Ofreneo, 2007).

A key initiative was in the development of human rights education in the school system. As part of its mandate, the CHRP facilitated inter-agency cooperation among education agencies of the government (Ofreneo, 2007). The 1992 Joint Declaration of Undertaking between the Commission on Human Rights and the Department of Education, Culture and Sports formalized the partnerships among these agencies which had been underway since 1987. With this declaration, the

following initiatives were implemented: (1) Curriculum development involving integration of human rights and responsibilities across levels of formal and non-formal education; (2) Training and capacity building for various school level in undertaking human rights education; and (3) Regular monitoring, research and evaluation of human rights instructional materials development and information campaign.

Furthermore, during the UN Decade for Human Rights Education period (1995-2004), curriculum development on human rights was intensified through the development of human rights teaching exemplars. This facilitated the integration of the teaching of human rights in all subjects either as content-based instructions or as standalone sessions. By 2001, the developed exemplars were further revised in

partnership with the Department of Education (DepEd) to reconcile the exemplars with the newly instituted Revised Basic Education Curriculum. These were implemented nationwide from school year 2004 to 2005 and the subsequent years found CHRP and DepEd holding a series of regional book launchings, trainers training workshops, in-service education and training, and a series of regional and youth forums on human rights education. Through these programs and initiatives, the CHRP was able to mobilize government educational agencies to comply with its legal mandates and international obligations on human rights education. However, there is more to be done to fully realize the action plan for human rights education in the school system (Ofreneo, 2007).

B. Importance of Human Rights Education

Taking into account the 1993 World Conference on Human Rights in Vienna, human rights education was deemed essential for the "promotion and achievement of stable and harmonious relations among communities and for fostering mutual understanding, tolerance and peace" (OHCHR, Vienna Declaration). Education plays a key role in upholding human rights, supporting human development, and strengthening civil society (OMB, n.d). Human rights education can thus pave the way in building a culture of human rights in every community.

In democratic and pluralistic civil societies, human rights education is integral in ensuring participation in the democratic process. Through human rights education,citizens are able to engage in critical thinking, decide on moral issues, and take proper courses of action, guided by the fundamental values of human rights and democracy.

By equipping citizens with this essential knowledge, they can take responsibility in promoting and protecting human rights and values. Human rights education is critical in ensuring informed activism of individuals, non-government organizations, and people's organizations which will reinforce commitment to human

rights principles and policies and strengthen civil society (OMB, n.d.). Toward these ends, human rights education is important for people empowerment and for the development of various sectors.

Human rights education allows individuals to have a sense of increased respect and control over their own lives, enabling them to make decisions that will foster healthy, just, and dignified lives. Through human rights education, individuals

are equipped with the behaviors, attitudes, skills and knowledge needed to apply the human rights value system in their interpersonal relationships and within their communities. With proper education, human development skills are enriched as individuals are taught perspectives, initiatives, and actions that take conscious regard for human rights (OMB, n.d.).

Human rights education allows for the development of sectors. The goal is to be able to reach all groups since human rights is a concern of all. There are, however, key sectors targeted for human rights education because of their vulnerability as rights-holders, or their responsibility as duty-bearers. These sectors greatly influence human rights practices in a society, with each group having particular education and training needs that must be identified and addressed in human rights education.

Regardless of the audience, human rights education is important for conjuring appropriate and strategic methods and mechanisms for the transfer of knowledge, skills, attitudes, and behaviors.

C. Goals of human rights education

In the Plan of Action for the United Nations Decade for Human Rights Education 1995-2004 (OHCHR, Plan of Action, para. 2), human rights education was conceived to be directed toward the following aims:

1. To strengthen respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms;
2. To fully develop human personality and sense of its dignity;

3. To promote understanding, tolerance, gender equality and friendship among all nations, indigenous peoples and racial, national, ethnic, religious, and linguistic groups;
4. To enable all persons to participate effectively in a free society
5. To further the activities of the United Nations for the maintenance of peace.

These goals are undoubtedly inspiring in themselves, but in order to achieve freedom, justice, and peace, concrete actions have to be taken to address social, economic and political problems that plague society. To this end, the goals of human rights education are twofold: to learn about human rights and to learn for human rights (Flowers et al., 2000).

Coalition and alliance development: Human rights education can be effectively and efficiently disseminated to a larger audience or to many groups through the coordination of resources aimed toward a common program of action. Local, regional, and international advocates can be tapped to collaborate toward mutual human rights goals.

Regular and continuing education. Continuous efforts for education need to be sustained, developed, and reinforced. This is essential with the growing body of knowledge, as well as the growth of populations to whom information should be disseminated.

Ensured availability: Since human rights is for all, access to human rights education is something that should also be available for all as inherent to their rights.

Individual empowerment. This comprises a set of interrelated goals associated to personal empowerment and social change. These goals are healing, development of the community, and social transformation. This entails a movement from spreading information through human rights education to incorporating social change and development (Tibbitts, 2002).

An incorporation of the study by Tibbitts (2002) on emerging models for human rights education provides a guiding framework in classifying and focusing the goals of CHR on human rights education. The three models identified are Values and Awareness Model, Accountability Model, and Transformational Model. The goals and target groups for each level define the appropriate contents, strategies, use of learning theory, trainer standards, and evaluation (Tibbitts, 2002). This provides a structured approach for setting human rights education goals and functions as each of the three models refer to a general area for human rights education (OMB, n.d.).

The model describes the goal, function, and size of target populations for each level in the figure. The base of the model focused on 'Values and Awareness Building' is concerned with a larger audience for Basic Human Rights Education. The 'Accountability Formation' level is targeted for Human Rights Education for Professionals, while the top level concerns more targeted institutions and major organization for 'Transformational Human Rights Education.

CHAPTER 1V

BASIC CHRE/VALUES AND
AWARENESS BUILDING

Basic Human Rights Education (Values and Awareness Building), Being at the base of the pyramid (OMB, n.d.), the focus of human rights education in the

Values and Awareness Building level is the transmission and integration of basic knowledge on human rights into public values Tibbitts, 2000) through mediums that address the public in general. This is mainly done through formal schooling and public awareness campaigns, through its philosophical-historical approach. Its key goal is to

"pave the way for a world that respects human rights through an awareness of and commitment to the normative goals laid out in the Universal Declaration and other documents" (Tibbitts, 2002, p. 163). Among the examples associated under this goal are public information programs, such as public art and advertising, media

coverage,and community events, or curriculum development and integration programs, such as inclusion of human rights-related lessons/themes in subjects and in both formal and informal youth programs (OMB, n.d.; Tibbitts, 2002). By encouraging mass support for human rights, this approach places continuous pressure upon authorities to protect human rights. While this approach gives little emphasis on the development of skills, it can help in fostering critical thinking in the analysis of policy issues within a human rights framework. Strategies used are socialization, cultural consensus, expectation setting for social change, and legitimization of human rights framework (Tibbitts,
2002).

Human Rights Education for Professionals (Accountability Formation). The next level concerning Accountability Formation focuses on the legal and political aspects of professional responsibility of individuals and/or groups in monitoring human rights violations and advocating for the protection of these rights. The goal is to develop and enable people to be responsible leaders with a rights-based perspective and values (OMB, n.d.) as these target groups are directly or indirectly associated with the guaranteeing of human rights because of their professional roles. These groups need to be sensitized about the nature and potentials of human rights violations within their respective areas and roles. The target audience are lawyers, civil servants, medical professionals, enforcement officials, judges and judicial personnel, journalists and other media personnel, and social service workers, human rights advocates and monitors, among others. At this level, the emphasis is on human rights training toward these specialized areas where learner outcomes target both content and skill development.

This model necessitates concerted effort toward social change which can be achieved through identifying targets of reform at the community, regional, and national levels (Tibbitts, 2002).

Transformational human rights education. The top level of the model entails a more psychological-sociological approach (Tibbitts, 2002) as it concerns individuals or groups directly impacted by human rights violations, vulnerable



populations, and post-conflict societies. This model assumes that the personal and shared experiences in human rights violation of the target audiences will foster solidarity for them to become promoters and defenders of human rights themselves. The goal of human rights education programs at this level is to provide mechanisms and support systems specific to their experiences in their communities (OMB, n.d.). Being particular to disadvantaged sectors, this model promotes conscious regard for cultural and historical beliefs and backgrounds, political conditions, and community experiences. Empowerment initiatives are geared toward holistic development of individuals and may take the form of leadership development, conflict resolution

training, vocation training, and work and informal fellowship. This model usually operates in programs scen in refugee camps, post-conflict societies, and groups serving the poor or victims of domestic abus. However it may als be possible to attempt this in schools if links are made between family and school life, if an extensive agenda in the curriculum is laid out, and if intentional sustained community support is enforced (Tibitts, 2002).

Who needs human rights education?

Human rights education is basically for all since everyone has rights. It is needed for active citizenship in democratic and pluralistic societies. Furthermore, it is essential in promoting informed activism especially on human rights issues. Justice and peace in societies depend upon citizens who are well-informed and critical of human rights and their violations.

Local communities also need human rights education to ensure sensitization to human rights in everyday life situations. The goal of a universal culture of human rights mean that this culture is brought straight home to the individual lives of every member of the community. Human rights education is essential to a recognition of "unrealized injustices and discriminations" (Flowers et al., 2000) in local communities. By learning about human rights, and learning for human rights, individuals will be equipped to appropriately and effectively respond to violations found in their communities.





While everyone needs human rights education, there are also groups where such education is more critical to ensure their protection and security. These are the following (Flowers et al., 2000):

1. Young children and their parents. Developing attitudes about equality and human dignity should start at a young age where these attitudes are shown to be largely set.Education on and protection of human rights should begin within every home.
2. Teachers, principals, and educators of all kinds. The nature of the teaching profession is fundamentally grounded in its genuine concern for children. This will include protection and fulfillment of their human rights especially as ensconced in the Convention on the Rights of the Child. In providing education across all levels, educators must first have "human rights literacy" to ensure that the design, implementation, and evaluation of programs promotes and values human rights.
3. Doctors and nurses, lawyers and judges, social workers, journalists, police, and military officials. These groups need human rights education because of their propensity and capacity to actually violate human rights given the power or positions they hold. Human rights education should thus be integral in the curriculum of professional training institutions.
4. Vulnerable populations. These groups generally include refugees, minorities, migrant workers, indigenous people, persons with disability, and the poor, among others. Human rights education should be accessible most especially to these people who are especially vulnerable to human rights abuses and
5. violations due to a lack of knowledge and awareness of their rights and how they ought to respond.
6. Activists and non-profit organizations. While most social and economic issues brought forward by activists and non-profit organizations are related to human rights, their strategies and advocacy should be grounded in the human rights framework. Understanding these contexts are essential in ensuring that problems are adequately addressed and solidarity among these marginalized sectors is achieved.



7. Public office holders (elected or appointed). Serving the interests of the people in a democratic society should spring from a public commitment to human rights.

Regardless of the level or position held by a public official, it is essential that human rights education is known and applied by all office holders.

7. Power holders. This can range from members of business communities and religious leaders to anyone whose decision affect the lives of others. Power holders must be informed of the power that they wield and its capacity to impede or effect stability and development in communities and in the lives of people.

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